

FACEBOOK'S ACQUISITION OF WHATSAPP



Last month's biggest news story was Facebook's acquisition of Whatsapp for \$16 billion. Just why did Facebook choose to spend such a huge amount on a paltry messaging app? Sequoia Capital, the sole investor in Whatsapp, gives some numbers <http://dgit.in/wvWhatsapp>

ARE YOU DATING YOUR SMARTPHONE?



Smartphone owners' lives are almost controlled by their phones. It's the first thing we check in the morning and the last thing before sleeping. Here's some hilarious signs that you may be dating your phone! <http://dgit.in/wvsmartphone>

WHATSAPP ISN'T AS HUGE AS YOU THINK

While Facebook's acquisition of Whatsapp for \$16 billion seems to have shocked the Western world, regions like India where Whatsapp reigns supreme may be a little confounded. After all, WhatsApp IS the de-facto mobile messaging app right? Turns out, it's not; at least on a global scale. <http://dgit.in/wvWhatsapp>

CREATIVITY FROM SCRAP



Argentinean artist Elisa Naranja Metalica Insua uses everyday trash – ranging from disposed computer motherboards, coins, etc, to make wonderful art. Some of her masterpieces include Darth Vader, a dinosaur from Jurassic Park and the lion from the MGM commercial. <http://dgit.in/wvtrash>

fairly WhatsApp-ish, but Hike limits that information to just the contacts you have added to the friends list.

Quite frankly, we really like the simple interface, and yet Hike remains fairly feature rich. This can pretty much be the solid second IM app that you should have on your phone.



Viber

Price: Free

Available for: BlackBerry, iOS, Android, Bada and Windows Phone

Download: <http://www.viber.com/>

This started out in life as a video calling application, and many people tend to compare this to Skype. However, unlike Skype which was first built for the desktop and then made its way to the mobile platform, Viber was built to be on mobile first and later the desktop client was also made available. One of the neatest apps for video calls, recently expanded into text chatting, complete with groups and stickers! It's a bit like WhatsApp in one aspect – it scans your contacts list on the device to let you know which of your friends are using Viber.

Video calls to Viber friends are free, and the ability to set favorites saves the pain of scrolling through the entire contacts list every time. Plus, the video calls can be made

on Wi-Fi or 3G, which can be a massive help just in case one of the other networks isn't around or you don't want to rake up a huge data usage bill.

WeChat

Price: Free

Available for: BlackBerry, iOS, Android, S40, and Windows Phone

Download: <http://www.wechat.com/en/>

Last year when WeChat launched, it had a 190 million strong active user-base worldwide but didn't have too many Indians using the service. Its voice messaging feature or 'Hold-To-Talk' as it's called is supposed to be a feature unique to WeChat while Moments allows WeChat where to post images or text and share with their selected friends in a secure way. One of the best things is that the app is committed to remaining free. It has a host of features such as Live Chat which allows you chat in a group using voice. Members in the Live Chat will hear you immediately. Only one person can talk at a time though. Another interesting feature is chat history backup. This allows you to backup your chat history and restore it to your new device. Shake, Lookaround and Drift Bottle are features that help users make new friends. Shake connects you with people shaking the phone at the same time. Creepy, yes, but



might be fun if you're bored. Drift Bottle lets you "Throw" or send out a voice or text message. You then wait to see who will pick up your bottle and reply. Lookaround is simply a location based search of people using WeChat nearby.



Telegram

Price: Free

Available for: iOS and Android

Download: <https://telegram.org/>

The telegram slogan itself is "Taking back our right to privacy" so you can pretty much guess that the focus of this app is security and maintaining the integrity of your data. In terms of its interface it's a clone of WhatsApp with your standard activation process and things like "last seen" and a set of emoticons. It doesn't have the ability to record and send voice messages like WhatsApp nor does it have status messages. Maybe these are frivolous features compared to its core focus – things like encryption and self-destruct ability for your messages. It has an open API and protocol free for everyone. At least on paper it claims to have no limits on the size of your media and chats. To top it all off Telegram aims to be free forever. No ads. No subscription fees. What more could you ask for?